battling to keep the Black Sheep back.

He did have one new victory; he annexed the Hungarian principality of Wallachia, ruled over by the independent prince Mircea the Elder, and added it to his own empire. Not long after, Mircea died and his son Vlad took his place as Wallachia's prince and Mehmed's vassal. He would become known as Vlad Dracul, Vlad the Dragon; builder of Castle Dracul, father of the violent and bloodthirsty Wallachian prince Vlad the Impaler.[15]

IN THE SPRING OF 1415, the Emperor Manuel traveled with a small band of soldiers to the south of the Greek peninsula, where the last remaining bit of the Byzantine empire still survived. There, within the space of two weeks, the soldiers rebuilt the Hexamilion Wall. In Roman times it had stretched across the Isthmus of Corinth, protecting the south from invasion by land. It had long been in ruins, but rebuilding it guaranteed that the Turks would be able to conquer this final outpost of Byzantium only by sea.[16]

Mehmed might keep his treaty, but Manuel did not intend to put all of his faith in the sultan's goodwill. He had more trust in the Byzantine navy.